

Data sovereignty: What does compliance require in 2026?

Hill-Top Consultancy Expert Blog

Author: David Mensah, Security & Governance Partner

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In perspective

Data sovereignty asks where information is stored, where it is processed, who can access it, which laws apply, and how an organization can prove its controls work.

Start with classification and purpose

Classify data by sensitivity, regulatory obligations, business criticality, and legitimate use. Connect each class to approved locations, processing patterns, retention rules, access policies, and recovery expectations.

Sovereignty is also about people and operations

A database may be located in an approved region while support access, logs, backups, analytics, or managed services introduce a different jurisdictional exposure. Teams need an end-to-end map of data flows and operational access.

Design for evidence

Centralized identity, policy-as-code, audit trails, key management, asset inventories, and tested recovery procedures make it possible to answer compliance questions with confidence.

Key takeaways

- Map data flows and access, not only storage regions.
- Match controls to data classification and business purpose.
- Include suppliers, backups, logs, and support operations.
- Build evidence into the platform and delivery workflow.

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